

SKILLS GUIDE



Interpersonal skills to interpret the needs of users and direct them to the desired resources.



Excellent organizational ability for maintaining extensive catalogs and managing staff.



Patience to deal with requests from library users and track down elusive resources.



Analytical thinking skills to develop new or revised systems, procedures, and work flows.



Good computer skills for helping with online research and keeping abreast of new technologies.



Strong team-working skills for interacting with staff, volunteers, and community agencies.



ACADEMIC LIBRARIAN Works in higher education and research institutes, providing specialized and subject-specific support to students, teachers, and researchers.



MUSIC LIBRARIAN Manages a collection of musical scores, books, and recordings. Music libraries are held at colleges and universities, national archives, and by record companies.



MEDICAL LIBRARIAN Serves doctors, nurses, and families in health-care settings, managing medical documents on clinical trials, treatments, and procedures.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **ARCHIVIST** Stores and maintains materials that record the culture, history, and achievements of individuals or groups of people. These may include letters, photographs, maps, books, and objects. Archivists may work for community groups, military regiments, companies, or national bodies.
- ▶ **BOOKSELLER** Buys books from publishers or wholesale suppliers and sells them to customers. Helps customers track down hard-to-find books.
- ▶ **KNOWLEDGE MANAGER** Collects, stores, catalogs, and distributes printed and digital information within an organization. Most information scientists work in scientific, research, or technical companies to ensure that staff are kept up to date with new regulations and developments.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS English • Literature • Reading • Research • Public service • Sciences • History • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS To be considered a full librarian, a master's degree in library and information science is required.



LIFESTYLE Some libraries stay open late and over weekends, or host programs, so librarians may need to work beyond regular office hours.



LOCATION Most of the working day is spent within the library building at a school, college, hospital, or academic institution.



THE REALITIES Library users can be difficult, but helping people to find elusive information that they need can be rewarding.